Sometimes a route parameter that isn't always in the URI needs to be specified. Put a question mark (?) after the parameter name to do this. Make sure to assign a default value to the respective route variable:

```
Route::get('/user/{place?}', function (string $place = null) {
  return $place;
});
Route::get('/user/{place?}', function (string $place =
'London') {
  return $place;
});
```

Regular Expressions Constraints

Using the **`where`** method on a route object, you can restrict the format of your route arguments. The **`where`** method accepts a regular expression that specifies how the parameter should be constrained in addition to the parameter's name.

Note: Let's understand regular expressions before diving deep into the Regular expressions constraints.

Regular Expressions

Regex is short for regular expression. A string of various characters known as a regex, regexp, or regular expression describes a specific search pattern. Additionally, it is referred to or called a rational expression.

It is mostly utilized for text string manipulation and search. Simply said, regular expressions make it straightforward to look for patterns and replace them with those that match.

`*`

It is used to match strings with no restriction or rule. Generally used in combination with other rules.

`{}`

The number of times the previous regular expression should be applied is indicated by the integer values wrapped in.

`<^> or <$> or <[ A-Z]>`